His discussions with Akali leaders and Bhindranwale over, and Indira Gandhi's approval of the formulae worked out by him obtained, Swaran Singh travelled back to Delhi on or around 30 October 1982 and stayed with us in our Satya Marg, Chanakyapuri, flat. From what I observed during Singh's stay with us, Longowal had detailed Parkash Singh Badal and Balwant Singh as his messengers for exchange of messages or information to and from Swaran Singh. On the government's side, Swaran Singh interacted by phone with Pranab Mukherjee, then finance minister, who had been his colleague in Indira Gandhi's cabinet till November 1975.

Swaran Singh met members of the cabinet sub-committee on Punjab affairs and briefed them about his meetings with the Akali leaders and Bhindranwale. Regarding Bhindranwale's demand for the release of Amrik Singh and Thara Singh, Swaran Singh told them that in his view, based on his knowledge of criminal law, the cases against the two were weak and they would be released by the court on their very first appearance. So why not oblige Bhindranwale in a case which was bound to fall in court in any case? (In fact, both were subsequently discharged in the summer of 1983 and died during Operation Blue Star.)

Four senior Akali leaders – Parkash Singh Badal, Gurcharan Singh Tohra, Jagdev Singh Talwandi and Balwant Singh – reached New Delhi to participate in discussions with the cabinet sub-committee. On 2 November 1982, the two sides had detailed discussions on various issues related to the Akali demands. Consequently, it was agreed that all the religious demands be accepted, including the broadcasting of gurbani from the Golden Temple, enactment of the All India Gurudwara Act, allowing the carrying of a small kirpan on domestic flights, and the closure of tobacco, meat and liquor shops within a certain radius of the Golden Temple. There was agreement on some of the political demands too. However, the modalities had to be worked out and the concerned states consulted before a final decision was taken. There was some understanding on the Chandigarh issue too.

On the morning of 3 November, the cabinet committee met in P.V. Narasimha Rao's room in the Parliament House. Principal secretary to the PM, P.C. Alexander, Cabinet Secretary C.R.